SHARON SUNNY THOMAS

Indian School of Business, Hyderabad - 500111

Education

Indian School of Business - PhD Level Coursework **2024 – Present**

Capital Market Research in Accounting 2: Prof. Hariom Manchiraju

Special Topics in Financial Accounting Research: Prof. Karthik Balakrishnan

Credited two seminar-style courses focused on critically analyzing and presenting seminal accounting studies.
Replication Exercise: Ball & Brown (1968)
Literature Review: Textual Analysis in Accounting & Finance

Christ University - M.Sc. Economics & Analytics **2023**

Relevant Courses: Microeconomic Theory and Applications, Macroeconomic Theory and Policy, Python Programming, Statistics using R, Econometric Methods, Applied Econometrics, Applied Machine Learning, Behavioral Economics, **Applied Institutional Economics**.

University of Madras - B.Sc. Mathematics **2020**

Relevant Courses: Multivariate Calculus and Theory of Numbers, Discrete Mathematics, Linear Algebra, Real Analysis, Complex Analysis, Mathematical Statistics, Advanced Calculus, Programming in C, Introduction to Economics, **Financial Accounting and Management**.

Research Interests

Text as Data, Information Processing Costs, Disclosures, Technology.

Research Experience

Indian School of Business *Research Associate (Pre-Doc)* **Aug 2024 – Present**
↪ Prof. Rishabh Aggarwal - Accounting *Hyderabad, India*

- Contributed to the paper *Monetary Policy Exposure Uncertainty and Voluntary Disclosure*, complementing it with textual analysis by developing **Cosine Similarity** and **TF-IDF** models to quantify textual data in **Earnings Call** transcripts against the **Federal Reserve** communication transcripts.
- Replicated and extended papers using **MATLAB** and **Stata** to test whether the results hold for different measures of monetary policy uncertainity shocks.
- Applied topic modeling techniques **LDA** and **BERTopic** to SEC 10-K risk disclosures.
- Conducted literature reviews in Climate Finance and Dynamic Debt Contracting theory.
- Implemented web scraping methods for external data, extracted institutional data from **WRDS** via **SAS**, and ensured data integrity by using macros for large-scale dataset merging.
- Compiled data for assignments in the MBA course *Business Valuation using Financial Statements*.

Replications: Armstrong et al. (2013) | Gertler & Karadi (2015) | Ottonello & Winberry (2020)

Indian School of Business *Research Intern* **Jun 2024 – Aug 2024**
↪ Prof. Gurvinder Sandhu - Accounting *Remote*

- Transformed a complex, inherited codebase with multiple undocumented functions into a linear, well-documented implementation with markdowns, significantly improving code readability.
- Assisted in research projects involving **Compustat**, **CRSP**, integrating legacy and new **DealScan** datasets.
- Matched RSSD IDs from **Call Reports** with Lender IDs in DealScan.
- Developed a Python program to extract directors with specific industry experience from **SEC filings**, using Named Entity Recognition with **spaCy**.

National Council of Applied Economic Research *Intern → Research Associate* **Jan 23'– May 23' – Jun 24'**
↪ Prof. Bornali Bhandari - Trade Technology & Skills *Delhi, India*

- Web-scraped nationwide restaurant data from a food delivery platform.
- Automated scripts for daily cleaning and storage of incoming survey data with geospatial plotting to track coverage and progress.
- Independently developed a **Progressive Web App (PWA)** using **JavaScript** for survey data collection.
- All projects were survey-based, and I was actively involved in the end-to-end process, including literature review, development, questionnaire design, pilot testing, monitoring, and fieldwork.

Projects: Gig Economy Initiative | Evaluation of Equity Support to IIFCL | Telecom Sector External Profile | Impact of Aadhaar on GDP | Impact of Aadhaar Enrolment and Updation Ecosystem on Individuals

Reports Published:
1. *Socio-economic Impact Assessment of Food Delivery Platform Workers* (August 2023)
2. *National Skill Gap Study for High Growth Sectors* (June 2025)

National Council of Applied Economic Research *Summer Intern* **May 2022 - Jul 2022**
↪ Prof. Sonalde Desai - National Data Innovation Centre *Delhi, India*

- Translated the questionnaire into Tamil language for the India Human Development Survey (IHDS-3), a multi-topic panel survey of households across India.

Industry Experience

Telus International AI *Internet Assessor* **Feb 2020 – Sep 2021**

- Evaluated and ranked webpages in accordance with Google Page Quality standards.

Armstrong Capital Advisory Pvt. Ltd. *Investment Advisor Intern* **Jun 2019 – Sep 2019**

- Analyzed stocks and mutual funds to evaluate company holdings in portfolios.
- Attended fund meetings and conference calls organized by the Asset Management Companies.

Academic Achievements

- Scored 100% in Mathematics in both Secondary and Higher Secondary State Public Examinations.
- Ranked in the top 2% among 200,000 candidates in the Tamil Nadu State Engineering Admissions (TNEA).
- Recipient of a full merit admission from the Government of Tamil Nadu for undergraduate studies in Mathematics at the University of Madras.

Additional Information

Certification	*Certificate in Financial Modelling* - IMS Proschool & NSE (2019)
Programming Languages	Python, Stata, SAS, LaTeX MATLAB, R, JavaScript
Datasets	Compustat, CRSP, Earnings Call Transcripts, DealScan, SEC Filings
Languages	English, Tamil, Malayalam, Hindi

References

Prof. Rishabh Aggarwal
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